

— MEETING NO. 2 —

SHAPING THIS TOGETHER.

DATE

TUE · 25 AUG 2026

TIME

2:00 — 3:15 PM MT

LOCATION

**SPENCER FOX ECCLES BUSINESS BUILDING
CHILD HALL, RM 7180**

TODAY'S AGENDA.

00	INTRODUCTIONS	15 MIN
01	BUSINESS OF SPORTS ACADEMIC UPDATE	8 MIN
02	COLLABORATIVE EFFORTS	8 MIN
03	PLAYERS ACADEMY	15 MIN
04	PRIORITIES · Q3 + Q4	5 MIN
05	STUDENT ATTRIBUTES DISCUSSION	14 MIN
06	WHERE WE NEED HELP	10 MIN

WELCOME

David Eccles
School of Business
THE UNIVERSITY OF UTAH

— THE PEOPLE IN THE ROOM

INTRODUCTIONS.

A founding group of industry leaders, and the team building the Business of Sports at the David Eccles School of Business.

TIMEBOX

15 MINUTES

THE ADVISORY GROUP.

Senior leaders shaping the next generation of sports leaders.



MARK HARLAN

Athletics Director

CHARMELLE GREEN

Deputy Athletics Director /
COO

JASON GRECO

Executive Senior Associate
AD

University of Utah



CHRIS BARNEY

President, Revenue &
Commercial Strategy
Smith Entertainment Group



RICHARD BEZEMER

Strategic Advisor
Utah Olympic Legacy
Foundation



JIM BROWN

Founder & CEO
JBC International LLC



SPENCER P. ECCLES

Co-Founder & Managing
Director
The Cynosure Group



JOHN KIMBALL

President
Real Salt Lake & Utah
Royals



SCOTT DOUGHMAN

President's Office, Olympic
Planning

**JASON BURROW-
SANCHEZ**

Faculty Athletic
Representative
University of Utah



JIM OLSON

President
Utah Jazz



NATHAN RAFFERTY

President & CEO
Ski Utah



JUSTIN SIBLEY

Chief Executive Officer
ERIC WOODRUFF
SVP Technology & People
POWDR



MICHELLE SMITH

President
Miller Sports +
Entertainment



**ERIN TRENBEATH-
MURRAY**

VP of Philanthropy
Ken Garff Enterprises

THE TEAM.



KURT DIRKS

Dean & Professor of
Leadership



GRANT BARTH

Senior Advisor to the Dean
& Assistant Professor



MOLLY MAZZOLINI

Executive in Residence



MONET FRANK

Assistant Director of
Development



MICHAEL RUECKERT

Adjunct Professor, Sports
Marketing



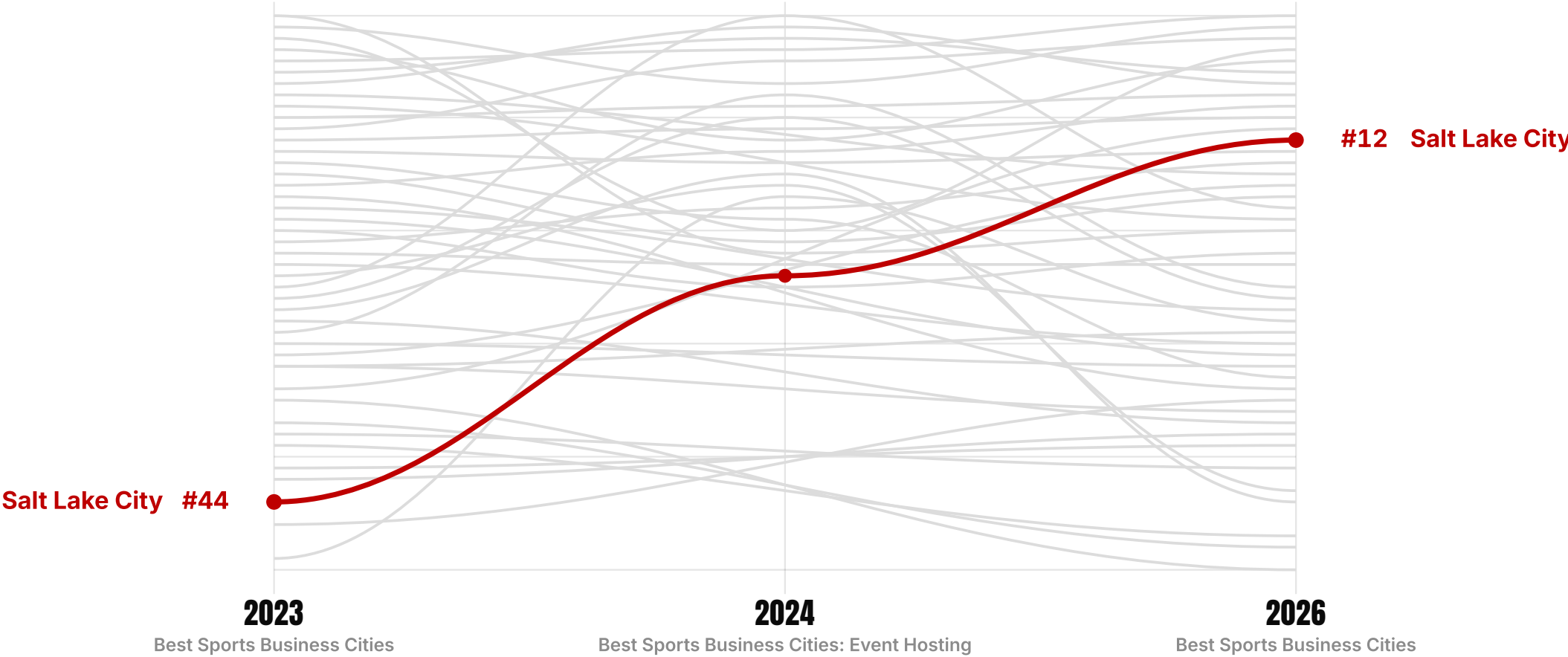
AUDREY ARTZ

Student & Intern



BEST SPORTS CITIES RANKINGS.

Salt Lake City climbed 32 places, from #44 in 2023 to #12 in 2026. No other city on either list moved further.





FOCUS 01

ANALYTICS

TURNING NUMBERS **INTO STRATEGY.**

- Sponsorship ROI
- Media rights valuation
- Athlete analytics
- Data-driven decisions



FOCUS 02

BRANDS

WHERE SPORT **MEETS CULTURE.**

- Brand & product development
- Storytelling & activation
- Athlete brand management
- Culture intersection



FOCUS 03

EXPERIENCES

FROM CONCEPT **TO LEGACY.**

- Venue design
- Corporate partner integration
- Universal access & experience innovation
- Community impact & legacy
- Event management & operations

WOVEN THROUGH
EVERY COURSE

01 ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

02 FAN ENGAGEMENT

03 SALES STRATEGY

AT THE CENTER OF THE CAMPUS.

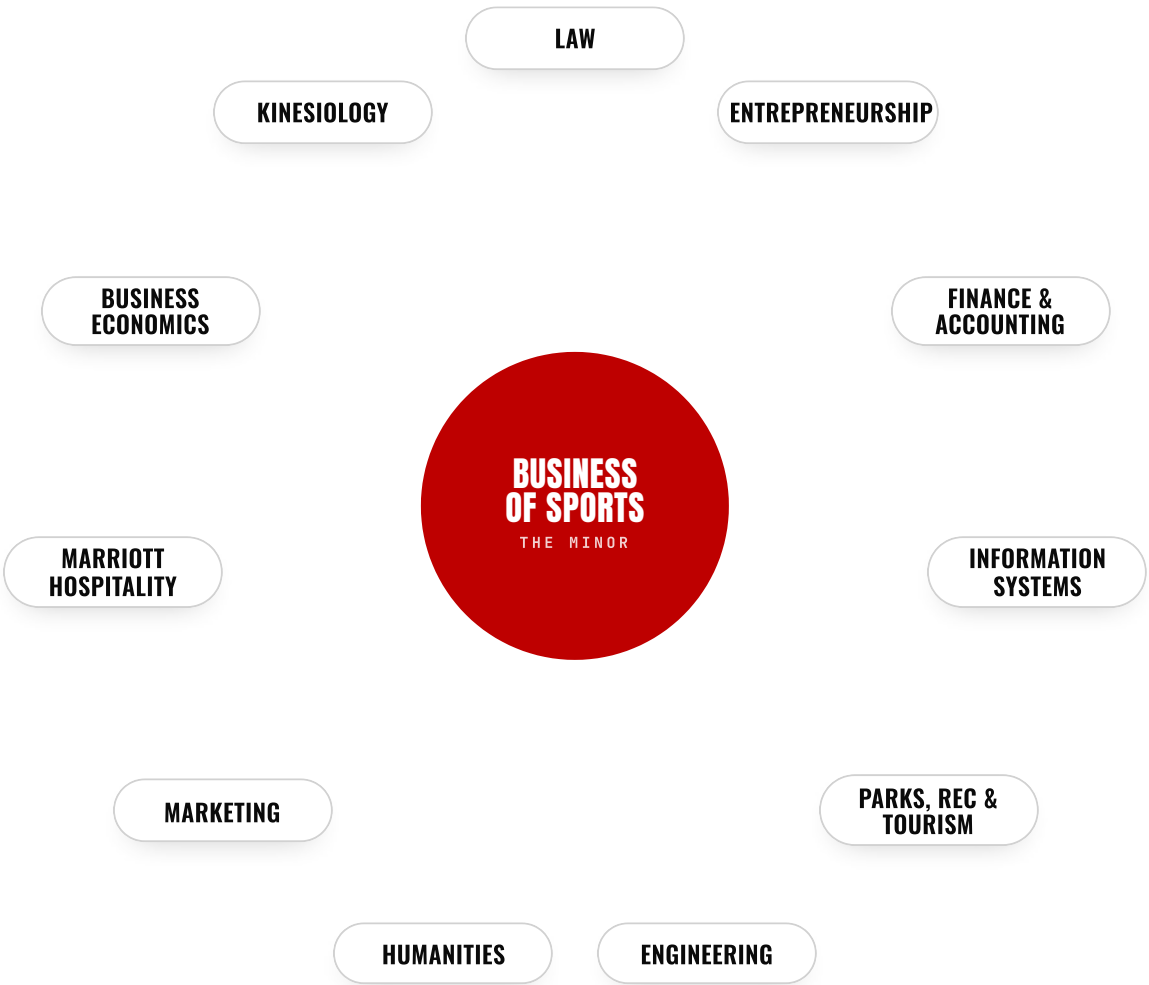
ENROLLMENT PROJECTION

YEAR 1 FY28		40–60
YEAR 2 FY29		130–170
YEAR 3 FY30		200+

STUDENTS ENROLLED, CUMULATIVE

– THE LABOR MARKET

Sport management was a **Top 10 U.S. job** in 2023, median **\$88,720**, with about **99,000 openings a year** through 2034.



— STATUS AND PATHWAY FORWARD

ACADEMIC UPDATE.

Where the minor stands today, what runs in the classroom this year, and the schedule that carries us to a Fall 2027 launch.

TIMEBOX

8 MINUTES



- THE MINOR

18
CREDITS

Open to every University of Utah undergraduate.

PROGRAM STRUCTURE.

9
CREDITS
CORE

- Sports Business Leadership Speaker Series
- Marketing Vision or Principles of Marketing
- Intro to Sports Business

3
CREDITS
EXPERIENTIAL

- Sports Business Internship / Capstone Project, delivered by the PLAYERS Academy

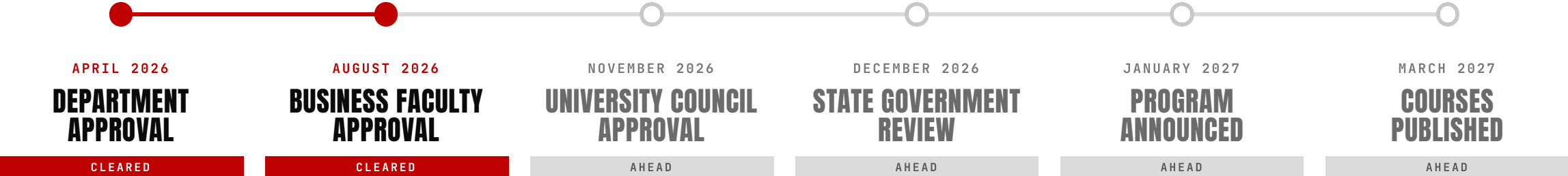
6
CREDITS
ELECTIVES
CHOOSE 2

- Sports Analytics
- Sports Marketing
- Sports Product Management

+
FUTURE
ELECTIVES

- Sport Brand Management
- Sales in Sports
- Olympics & Paralympics
- Event Management and Facility Operations

WHAT WE'VE CLEARED.



THE ROAD TO LAUNCH.

UNTIL FIRST CLASS
361 : **17** : **03** : **00**
DAYS HRS MIN SEC

SPRING 2026

MILESTONES

- Business of Sports minor proposal submitted
- Advisory Group first meeting
- Student Research Team: competitive landscape and student interest

ENGAGEMENT

- Eccles Experience Magazine: Chris Barney, Jim Olson, Elaina Pappas, SEG feature

SUMMER 2026

MILESTONES

- Department and faculty approvals cleared
- 18-credit curriculum finalized
- PLAYERS Academy model built
- Advisory Group reconvened

ENGAGEMENT

- Eccles Business Buzz Podcast: Jim Olson feature

FALL 2026

MILESTONES

- Launch of the Sports Business Leadership Speaker Series
- PLAYERS Academy test event with Utah Baseball
- University Council review

ENGAGEMENT

- Eccles Experience Magazine: Coach Scalley feature and Business of Sports teaser article
- Sports Business Association meetups
- Business of Sports stakeholder night out (Jazz, Mammoth, RSL)

SPRING 2027

MILESTONES

- Sports Marketing offered
- Curriculum through academic approval
- Readiness coursework built & piloted

ENGAGEMENT

- Sales Innovation Summit: Chris Barney keynote
- Lassonde Sports Entrepreneurship Summit
- Eccles Alumni Forum
- Business of Sports Ambassador recruitment

FALL 2027

MILESTONES

- Minor officially launches
- PLAYERS Academy goes live
- First capstone showcase scheduled

— BUILDING WITH PARTNERS

COLLABORATIVE EFFORTS.

Three relationships moving in parallel: a peer program, the Olympic movement, and Utah Athletics.

TIMEBOX

8 MINUTES

WHO WE'RE BUILDING WITH.



PEER PROGRAM

GRANT BARTH

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON

Learning from a gold-standard sports business program: industry connections, product management depth, and faculty drawn from the field.

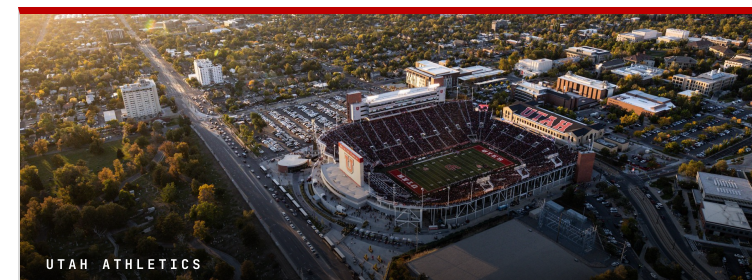


OLYMPIC & PARALYMPIC MOVEMENT

SCOTT DOUGHMAN

UNIVERSITY OF UTAH * OLYMPICS & PARALYMPICS

How the university capitalizes on 2034: internships and jobs for our students, and a stage that distinguishes Utah globally, with Opening & Closing Ceremony plus Athlete Village on campus.



UTAH ATHLETICS

CHARMELLE GREEN

UTAH ATHLETICS & CRIMSON BRAND PARTNERS

A college-athletics-first move into private equity partnership. Cutting-edge sports business development our students can collaborate with and learn from.

— THE EXPERIENTIAL ENGINE

THE PLAYERS ACADEMY.

Professional Learning and Year-round Experiential Readiness. The platform that turns the required 3-credit experience into real placements.

TIMEBOX

15 MINUTES

WHERE STUDENTS GO.

01

COLLEGE ATHLETICS

Utah Athletics & Crimson
Brand Partners, the anchor
tenant.

02

MAJOR LEAGUE

The franchises anchoring Salt
Lake's professional identity.

03

EMERGING LEAGUE

The new leagues writing the
next chapter of Utah sport.

04

HOSPITALITY & RESORTS

Ski resorts, venue hospitality,
and destination operators.
Where sport meets service.

05

CONSUMER BRANDS

Utah-made gear. The brand
bench of the outdoor industry.

06

HEALTH & WELLNESS

The performance & recovery
sector: nutrition, equipment,
training.

07

OLYMPIC & NGBs

The Olympic movement and
the governing bodies
headquartered here.

08

EVENTS & ORGS

The events & organizations
that move Utah's sports
calendar.

— WHAT IS THE PLAYERS ACADEMY?

PARTNERSHIP PLATFORM.

PROFESSIONAL LEARNING AND
YEAR-ROUND EXPERIENTIAL READINESS

The Business of Sports' dedicated experiential engine. A structured, accountable, credit-bearing program that places students inside Utah's sports industry with vetted employer partners.

FOR STUDENTS

Curated placements, academic credit, and a clear path from classroom to career in the sports industry.

FOR EMPLOYERS

Access to trained, motivated DESB talent with structured onboarding expectations and defined responsibilities.

FOR THE PROGRAM

Real-world outcomes that strengthen the minor's credibility, donor appeal, and industry reputation.

QUESTIONS.

01

INVOLVEMENT

What would meaningful student involvement practically look like inside your organization: number of students, project duration, mentorship, recruiting access, something else?

02

VALUE

What would make this genuinely valuable enough for your organization to prioritize this partnership?

03

BARRIERS

What barriers (HR, legal, managerial capacity, timing, compensation, student readiness) would we need to solve?

04

RELATIONSHIP

Beyond access to talent, what would you want out of a relationship with the Business of Sports program?

05

AMBITION

If this became the premier university-to-industry talent platform in sports, what role would you want your organization to play, and what would it take to get there?

06

BLIND SPOTS

What are we overlooking that could make this truly distinctive?

THE TEST EVENT.

We run the model live with **Utah Baseball**, in the new facility. Real students, real deliverables, real feedback – for coaches and student-athletes. A full year before the requirement goes live.

FUTURE CONCEPTS.

Utah Athletics is already thinking of the next version, inside the department that runs every program. Real staff, real events, real fan-facing work, ready for cross-campus integration and collaboration.

- WHERE IT HAPPENS

**CHARLIE MONFORT FIELD
AMERICA FIRST BALLPARK****UTAH ATHLETICS**

Q3 + Q4 PRIORITIES.

THIRD QUARTER

VALIDATE. DESIGN. RECRUIT.

Pressure-test the model, refine the partner value proposition, and build the founding employer pipeline.

- Advisory Group No. 2 feedback captured and actioned
- Utah Baseball test event executed
- Curriculum package prepared for academic review

FOURTH QUARTER

BUILD + COMMIT

Translate industry insight into a launch-ready model and early commitments.

- University Council approval & state government review
- PLAYERS Academy x Utah Baseball pilot program
- Continued Business of Sports awareness with sports industry stakeholders

WHAT DOES A BUSINESS OF SPORTS GRADUATE LOOK LIKE?

-
- 01**
INDUSTRY
- Relevant content and genuine fluency in the business of sports.
-
- 02**
DURABLE
- Communication, leadership, and critical thinking. What sports employers actually value.
-
- 03**
APPLIED
- Real work, inside the sports industry, before they graduate.
-
- 04**
TEAMWORK
- Collaboration built into every project, not an afterthought.
-
- 05**
BUSINESS
- A real business education under the sports focus. Many sports management programs sit outside the business school; ours sits inside it.



— THE OUTCOME
**READY ON
DAY ONE**

WHERE WE NEED HELP.

The program is real and the timeline is set. What we need now is the part we can't build ourselves.

– PHILANTHROPY

INVEST

Future philanthropic support that fuels student opportunity and helps position the Business of Sports program for long-term impact and scale.

– PERSPECTIVE

ENGAGE

Bring industry perspective into the student experience through classroom conversations, guest lectures, panels, and signature Eccles events.

– OPPORTUNITY

EMPLOY

Create meaningful pathways from classroom to career through internships, project-based experiences, and employment opportunities within the PLAYERS Academy.

– MENTORSHIP

ADVISE

Mentor students, share industry perspective, and help us shape a differentiated model for developing the next generation of sports business talent.

— THANK YOU

ASCENT BEGINS **HERE.**

DAVID ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS • UNIVERSITY OF UTAH
ADVISORY GROUP MEETING NO. 2 • 25 AUGUST 2026